

submission

-  My Files
-  My Files
-  University

Document Details

Submission ID**trn:oid:::3618:114267411****Submission Date****Sep 25, 2025, 6:23 PM GMT+5:30****Download Date****Sep 25, 2025, 6:23 PM GMT+5:30****File Name****ENG130-dISCUSION 3.docx****File Size****13.6 KB****1 Page****421 Words****2,193 Characters**

0% Overall Similarity

The combined total of all matches, including overlapping sources, for each database.

Filtered from the Report

- Bibliography
- Quoted Text

Match Groups

-  **0** Not Cited or Quoted 0%
Matches with neither in-text citation nor quotation marks
-  **0** Missing Quotations 0%
Matches that are still very similar to source material
-  **0** Missing Citation 0%
Matches that have quotation marks, but no in-text citation
-  **0** Cited and Quoted 0%
Matches with in-text citation present, but no quotation marks

Top Sources

- 0%  Internet sources
- 0%  Publications
- 0%  Submitted works (Student Papers)

Integrity Flags

0 Integrity Flags for Review

No suspicious text manipulations found.

Our system's algorithms look deeply at a document for any inconsistencies that would set it apart from a normal submission. If we notice something strange, we flag it for you to review.

A Flag is not necessarily an indicator of a problem. However, we'd recommend you focus your attention there for further review.

Match Groups

- 
0 Not Cited or Quoted 0%
 Matches with neither in-text citation nor quotation marks
- 
0 Missing Quotations 0%
 Matches that are still very similar to source material
- 
0 Missing Citation 0%
 Matches that have quotation marks, but no in-text citation
- 
0 Cited and Quoted 0%
 Matches with in-text citation present, but no quotation marks

Top Sources

- 0%  Internet sources
- 0%  Publications
- 0%  Submitted works (Student Papers)

Discussion 3: Second Person POV in How to Make Love to a Physicist

The fictional story, "How to Make Love to a Physicist" by Deesha Philyaw's enabled me to grasp and fully explore the second-person point of view. At first, I found the idea of using "you" to narrate a story quite intriguing, and was not certain of what to make of it. However, as I read the story, I came to understand this approach was not experimental. Instead it was essential to its emotional impact and thematic depth. The choice to use "you" throughout isn't just stylistic, it's transformative. In essence, the second-person POV creates a sense of intimacy and immediacy. For instance, when Philyaw writes "You take out your charcoal and sketch his face from memory," she's not just telling us about Lyra's experience, rather she's pulling us directly into it. It's more immediate than third-person would be, yet it maintains a certain distance that first-person might not allow. The "you" makes us complicit in Lyra's journey of self-discovery. We become Lyra and feel her hesitation, her fear, and her gradual awakening to self-love and acceptance. It's like the narrator is our inner voice, guiding us through this transformation.

What really struck me was how this POV choice mirrors the story's central theme. Lyra spends most of her life disconnected from her own body, letting others define her worth. The "you" format forces us to inhabit her body, to experience her journey from self-denial to self-acceptance firsthand. When she finally sleeps naked and explores her own body, we're right there with her. It's vulnerable in a way that first-person might feel too confessional and third-person too distant. Moreover, the repetitive structure, "How do you make love to a physicist?" creates this ritualistic quality. Each section builds on the last, like instructions or a recipe. But they're not just instructions for loving Eric. They're instructions for loving yourself. For breaking free from your mother's shame. For finding your voice through art. For choosing courage over fear.

If Philyaw had written this in first person, it might have felt too personal, too specific to just Lyra's experience. Third person would have created distance when the story demands closeness. But second person makes this one woman's journey feel universal. Every reader becomes the protagonist, working through their own relationship with desire, self-worth, and the courage to be vulnerable. The POV choice transforms what could have been simply Lyra's story into something much more powerful, a roadmap for anyone learning to love themselves.